

CROOKED

Written by

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Based on, If Any

Logline: When a meter maid crosses paths with a junkie up to no good, they must work together to take down the looming drug syndicate that threatens its hold over the city.

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EXT. STOREFRONT - DAY

The front of a car. Static. Dusty. We peer inside the messy interior until:

A hand lifts and sticks a piece of paper behind the windshield wiper.

OFFICER AUBREY JONES (30) walks along several cars parked along the storefront. She wears the classic black and blue uniform in standard Meter Maid fashion. Ticket generator in one hand.

She stops in front of a gray sedan parked in front of a--

EXT. BANK - CONTINUOUS

She tracks around the back. Stares at the SCRATCH MARKS scattered around the trunk keyhole.

She rubs her fingers along the surface, before briskly walking down the--

EXT. STOREFRONT - CONTINUOUS

She spots an ELDERLY WOMAN approaching her direction. She nods her way as:

The Elderly Woman passes by, Jones steps into her--

INT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

It's a three-wheeled, slightly unstable, blue and white, almost two-seater abomination of a vehicle.

She pulls out a bulky laptop sitting beside her.

TERA (V.O.)

Kyle!

CUT TO:

INT. BANK - CONTINUOUS

TERA (30's), dressed in casual clothing with a black ski mask scrunched atop her head, treads towards the entrance of an open

VAULT

Duffle bag in hand.

KYLE (20's) leans against the outside

HALLWAY

Music bursts through the earbuds in his ears.

TERA

KYLE!

He jolts up, takes an earbud out.

TERA (CONT'D)

Here!

She chucks the duffle bag his way. Kyle catches, startled.

MORGAN (30's) stands in the

COMMON AREA

Ski mask on, assault rifle out. He corners a dozen CIVILIANS, huddled on the floor.

MORGAN

We wanna make this easy for you guys. So long as you keep following our instructions, we won't hurt anyone... So long as we get what we want, we won't hurt anyone...

He crouches down next to a well dressed man, THE MANAGER (50's).

MORGAN (CONT'D)

(softer)

So long as what you've told us is correct, we won't hurt anyone.

We peer inside the

MANAGER'S OFFICE

where a crouched unmasked CANNAN (30's) spins the dial to a safe.

INT/EXT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

BEEEEEP! The laptop chime alerts Jones to the screen. She hunches forward, to see:

The ID of the gray sedan owner: A clear image of an elderly woman.

Jones peers her head out the side of the car to see the Elderly Woman slowly approaching the gray sedan.

Jones slumps back into her seat, sighing.

INT. BANK - CONTINUOUS

Tera and Kyle scurry into the

COMMON AREA

They're carrying several duffle bags. They drop two on the ground as they put on their ski masks.

TERA
We're behind!

Morgan turns around to face them.

MORGAN
Is that everything?

He makes his way towards the duffel bags.

KYLE	TERA
(to Tera)	(re: Cannan)
By half //a minute.	//Is he done yet?

MORGAN
(to Tera)
Evidently not.

CANNAN (O.S.)	KYLE
(to Tera)	(to Morgan)
Did you say //half a minute?	//I need the pick.

MORGAN
(to Kyle)
Oh, right.

Morgan searches his pockets. Finds both of them empty.

TERA	MORGAN (CONT'D)
(to Cannan)	//Shit.
How much //longer is it going to take?	

KYLE
(to Morgan; noticing)
What do you mean "Shit"? //We just opened the trunk a second ago!

CANNAN (O.S.)
(to Tera)
//Hey, suck my dick! Why don't you have at it then!

MORGAN
(sternly)
Cannan!

CANNAN

slowly opens the safe door. A beat, then:

CANNAN
Sorry.

MORGAN

pulls out a pick and hands it to Kyle.

KYLE
(grabbing)
Thank you.

A masked Cannan enters the common area and hands a tiny black bag, smaller than his hand, to Morgan, who lugs a duffle bag over his shoulder. Tera stands over the civilians.

Morgan looks inside the bag. A beat then:

MORGAN
Listen guys... we've got what we came here to get. There needn't be any more conflict from here on out.
(to Tera)
How behind are we now?

TERA
A minute, almost two now.

MORGAN
Then let's go.

They make their way towards the entrance as:

We pan down to the Manager's hands behind his back, to reveal a rectangular shaped remote with a blinking red LED on the side.

MANAGER'S OFFICE

A blinking red LED glows from underneath the Manager's desk.

EXT. BANK - MOMENTS LATER

Kyle and Morgan bust through the front doors. Kyle almost runs into the Elderly Woman standing by.

KYLE

Sorry!

Cannan and Tera follow out.

INT/EXT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

Alerted by Kyle's shout, Jones looks their direction. Steps just outside of the car.

EXT. BANK - CONTINUOUS

MORGAN

Just get in the car man...

KYLE

I said I was sorry!

Morgan nudges Kyle to the side and opens the door to the sedan.

ELDERLY WOMAN

Heyyyy... my car.

CANNAN

(hunching over)

Sorry m'am, we need it for official business. We promise we'll bring it back in once piece.

Cannan stands up straight. He holds the car the car door open as:

He spots Jones standing down the street, staring straight at him.

Cannan hesitates.

INT/EXT. GRAY SEDAN - CONTINUOUS

Morgan, in the driver seat, looks off to his side.

MORGAN

Cannan, what are you doing? Get in the car.

Cannan throws in his duffle bag.

INT/EXT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

Jones steps forward, unsure.

Cannan and Jones both lock eyes once again - until Cannan hops inside and the gray sedan speeds off.

JONES

Fuck!

INT/EXT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

She inserts her key and drives off. Passing the Elderly Woman on her way.

CUT TO:

INT. BULLPEN, POLICE PRECINCT - CONTINUOUS

About a dozen officers crowd around SERGEANT MATTHEWS (50's).

MATTHEWS

(pointing at map)

...down the street of Danson and Highsmith. Now here is the intersection you guys will be at according to Warren.

(nodding towards Warren)

It's the height of rush hour, be careful. You all know your routes. Godspeed ladies and gentlemen... and... androids.

A pale skinned officer claps robotically as the other officers dissipate. This is WARREN (N/A), the android on desk duty.

WARREN

Well done Sergeant Matthews!

Matthews ignores him as he walks into--

INT. CHIEF'S OFFICE, POLICE PRECINCT - CONTINUOUS

CHIEF ORSON LOWLOTZ sits at his desk. He's quite bigger than average. Wears a white collared shirt and black tie.

Matthews closes the door behind him.

MATTHEWS

Chief...

INT/EXT. METER MAID CAR - MOMENTS LATER

Jones speeds and rams into the back of the--

INT. GRAY SEDAN - CONTINUOUS

The group of robbers jolt with the impact.

MORGAN

What the fuck was that!

Cannan looks behind him.

CANNAN

That bitch!

INT/EXT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

Jones tries to regain control of her car, but she can't keep up with the movement around her and the car begins to spin out.

INT. GRAY SEDAN - CONTINUOUS

MORGAN

Deal with it!

Cannan hands Kyle an assault rifle from the front seat. Kyle aims through the back window, watching Jones loses control of her car.

He relaxes. Laughs.

KYLE

It's dealt.

Morgan looks back through the window and laughs as:

A large black police SUV tanks into the side of the car, pulling it across the--

EXT. INTERSECTION - CONTINUOUS

--and bringing the gray sedan to a gripping halt on the front steps of a museum.

INT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

Jones, defeated and helpless, eyes the action that is happening down the street.

Red and Blue lights flash against her face from the side. Sirens, creeping in...

She looks to her left.

EXT. CITY STREET - CONTINUOUS

A swarm of blaring police cars track around the corner of a building.

INT. BLARING POLICE CAR - CONTINUOUS

COMMUNICATIVE OFFICER
Approaching on-site to the 10-65.
Intersection is inbound.

EXT. LEADING STREET - CONTINUOUS

Jones's car almost extends completely across the width of the street.

The police cars pool in one-by-one needling through the slight space behind her car.

INT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

JONES
Sorry!

EXT. MUSEUM - CONTINUOUS

The group of robbers trails from the crashed car to the front steps, frantic. Tera carries an injured Kyle.

A police car is stopped out front, the doors open, two police branded ANDROIDS step out.

They run straight towards Morgan, pulling out a concealed pistol.

BHAM!! CLANK!! BHOOOM!! CLANK!! PHEWW!! CLANK!!

Morgan keeps firing... The Androids keep coming. He runs out of ammo as the Androids overpower them all. They handcuff them, and begin to bring them down the steps.

INT. METER MAID CAR - CONTINUOUS

An angry officer stands outside the front window and looks straight at Jones. She tilts her head back and closes her eyes.

LOWLOTZ (PRE-LAP)
How many times are we going to have
to go through this?

INT. CHIEF'S OFFICE, POLICE PRECINCT - LATER

LOWLOTZ
You are not an officer of the law.

Matthews stands besides Lowlotz at his desk. Jones sits across from them.

JONES
I saw what they did... They we're
about to get away--

LOWLOTZ
That's not your job Jones.

JONES
I know...

Jone's looks down. Matthews steps forward. She looks back up.

MATTHEWS
Do you know how much havoc you
caused today with the stunt you
pulled? Half the precinct here
wants you gone.

JONES
I'm sorry, I was just trying to--

MATTHEWS
Help? All the people behind you
want to help. The very nature of
their jobs are: to help. And you do
too, just in a slightly different
way.
(leans over table)
But they can't do that unless you
get out of the way.

LOWLOTZ

That's enough Matthews.

(a deep sigh)

What he's trying to say is... To be blunt... you're not very needed.

Jones stunned, takes a moment.

JONES

The people in the bank were scared.
They had Machine guns--

MATTHEWS

(quickly)

AK's.

JONES

AK's, whatever! My point is, I was there. I was the only one around. I had to do something.

LOWLOTZ

Listen, Aubrey, we admire your dedication, really - but sometimes your dedication can do more bad than good.

Jones looks faltered.

LOWLOTZ (CONT'D)

I'm switching your zones.

(pulls out a book)

You'll take...

(skims through pages)

Alfie's old zone.

JONES

Oh come on, Alfie's old zone was bullshit, that's why no one does that crap anymore.

(a pause, then quickly)

Give me Terry's.

LOWLOTZ

Oh, you want Terry's?

JONES

Yes.

LOWLOTZ

You're getting Alfie's.

Jones slumps back in her seat.